



Breezy 72/65 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 83/58 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, APRIL 21, 2025 • \$4

High court will hear LGBTQ+ book case

Montgomery County parents seek to allow religious opt-outs

BY ANN E. MARIMOW

The debate over parental rights and religious freedom returns to the Supreme Court this week in a case testing whether families have a right to pull their kids from public school lessons featuring LGBTQ+-themed books at odds with their religious beliefs.

The lawsuit over story time and books with titles such as “Uncle Bobby’s Wedding” and “Love, Violet” touches on the type of diversity and inclusion efforts the Trump administration has targeted on college campuses, and in government and private businesses. It is one of three major religious-rights cases on the Supreme Court’s docket this term.

The court will consider next week whether states can directly fund religious schools, in a closely watched case involving a proposed Catholic charter school in Oklahoma. The justices are also set to decide whether Wisconsin must extend a tax exemption to the social services arm of the Catholic Church — a decision that could have implications for other large, religiously affiliated employers such as hospitals.

For the past decade or so, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. and the court’s conservative majority have consistently ruled in favor of strengthening religious freedoms and expanding the role of faith in public life.

The court has recognized that parents have an interest in directing their children’s religious

SEE SUPREME COURT ON A2

Md. schools: Case on LGBTQ+ content divides a diverse county. B1

Theft victims sue Apple in bid to reclaim digital lives

BY CHRIS VELAZCO

SAN FRANCISCO — Late in 2023, Robin Davis flew from her home in the Pacific Northwest to spend one weekend in New York City — and she planned to make the most of it.

She would meet up with a dear friend for dinner, then beline to a three-story nightclub on the Lower East Side for drinks and dancing at an ’80s-themed party. Then, they would catch a ride to a boutique hotel in SoHo, where they would trade stories and sleep in. It had all the makings of a perfect New York night — until, Davis said, a thief posing as a club employee drugged her, gleaned her iPhone’s passcode and ripped it from her hands as she was getting into an Uber.

As if the shopping spree the thief went on with her saved credit cards wasn’t bad enough, Davis has never regained access to the crucial files — contacts, photos from her wedding, data related to work “and other essential information” — associated with her Apple account. That’s not just because of the people who stole her phone. It’s also because Apple won’t give it back.

“As a career sales executive this

SEE APPLE ON A4

In Easter celebrations around the globe, east meets west



OLI SCARFF/AFP/GETTY IMAGES



RONEN ZVULUN/REUTERS



ANDRES KUDACKI/AP

Easter for Eastern Orthodox and Western churches fell on the same Sunday this year. Clockwise from top: Congregants at St. George Eritrean Orthodox Church in Birmingham, England; revelers at St. Patrick’s Cathedral in New York; and worshippers at the Church of the Holy Sepulchre in Jerusalem’s Old City.

Vance meets pope in private Vatican visit

BY NATALIE ALLISON, ANTHONY FAIOLA AND STEFANO PITRELLI

VATICAN CITY — Vice President JD Vance met with Pope Francis on Easter Sunday, the Vatican confirmed, a remarkable encounter between the ailing head of the global Catholic Church and a high-profile convert to the faith who has publicly criticized some of the church’s social teachings.

Francis later releases pointed Easter message decrying ‘logic of fear’

The vice president’s meeting with the pope was not announced in advance but was widely anticipated as Vance made something of a Catholic

pilgrimage to the Vatican over Easter, with Sunday being the faith’s holiest day.

The “private meeting” occurred at 11:30 a.m. at the papal residence, Casa Santa Marta, the Vatican said, and happened while Easter Mass was being said in St. Peter’s Square. “The meeting, which lasted a few minutes, gave them the opportunity to exchange Easter greetings,” the Vatican said in a statement.

Vance also met with Cardinal Pietro Parolin, the Vatican secretary of state and Francis’s No. 2, on Saturday.

“I know you’ve not been feeling great, but it’s good to see you in better health,” Vance said to Francis, sitting down facing the pope in his wheelchair.

“Thank you very much for your visit,” an interpreter for Francis said to the vice president.

SEE VANCE ON A8

Southeast Asia a new front in U.S.-China trade war

BY LILY KUO AND REBECCA TAN

Chinese leader Xi Jinping didn’t mention President Donald Trump once during his three-nation tour of Southeast Asia this month. But it was clear at every stop that Trump and his tariffs were on his mind.

In Vietnam this month, Xi invited Hanoi to join its communist brother in “opposing unilateral bullying.” In Malaysia, he spoke of recent “shocks to global order and economic globalization.” And in Cambodia, he said Beijing would work with Phnom Penh to resist “hegemony, power politics and bloc confrontation” — all terms Beijing has used in recent weeks to criticize Trump’s tariffs.

As China and the United States prepare for what’s expected to be a long and painful trade war, Southeast Asia is emerging as a first major battleground. And in a region where smaller countries are often sidelined in relations

SEE VIETNAM ON A9



MAIKA ELAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Workers in Binh Duong, Vietnam, weave string for deck chairs bound for the United States.

Surge strains ICE bed space

SOME MIGRANTS SLEEP ON FLOORS

DHS closed offices that monitored conditions

BY DOUGLAS MACMILLAN

At a crowded Miami detention center, some immigrants are being held in conference rooms with no toilets. The Cibola County prison in New Mexico doesn’t have enough chairs for all the immigrant detainees to eat their meals at a table. And at Prairieland Detention Center in Alvarado, Texas, some immigrant women have been forced to sleep on thin mats on the concrete floor because all the beds in the female holding unit are taken.

“You’re stripped from your humanity,” said América Platt, 29, who spent four sleepless nights on Prairieland’s floor after police arrested her on a warrant for an unresolved traffic ticket and turned her over to Immigration and Customs Enforcement. She was deported last month to Mexico, where she hadn’t lived since fleeing her abusive father two decades ago, she said.

The Trump administration’s efforts to boost deportations has increased the number of immigrant detainees so quickly that the government is failing to provide basic necessities, including beds and medical care, for some of them. Nearly half the people currently detained by ICE or Customs and Border Protection have no criminal charges, federal data show, yet some are being held in conditions that would be unacceptable in high-security prisons.

SEE ICE ON A14

Federal programs on fertility take big hit

BY SABRINA MALHI AND MERYL KORNFIELD

Federal programs that help people compare IVF clinics, monitor safety in fertility and make sense of health data have been scaled back by the Trump administration in a move some maternal health experts predict will have an enduring effect on women and children.

Layoffs at the Department of Health and Human Services this month have dismantled teams at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention responsible for collecting and analyzing data on a range of subjects, including embryo transfers and maternal health disparities.

Experts say the fallout will hit patients directly: Couples trying to conceive could lose access to information about clinics, treatments and their chances of success.

“We’ve been tracking this information for 38 years, and it’s improved mothers’ health and understanding of mothers’ experiences,” said Isaac Michael, a former mathematical statistician on the Pregnancy Risk Assessment Monitoring System (PRAMS) team, who was among those put

SEE FERTILITY ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Digital security lapse Sensitive documents were improperly shared with GSA staff under the Biden and Trump administrations. A4

Israeli inquiry The military said it dismissed a field commander and attributed the killings of 15 first responders in Gaza last month to an “operational misunderstanding.” A10

THE NATION **The Supreme Court** is set to hear arguments in a case concerning the legality of a government panel that makes it possible for Americans to receive preventive health care at no cost. A3

THE WORLD **Vice President JD** Vance’s trip to India, the first by an American vice president in more than a decade, comes as U.S. relations with New Delhi are in a period of relative calm. A7

THE ECONOMY **As more employers** tell workers to return to an office five days a week, anxiety is rising for many who identify as neurodivergent. A11

THE REGION **Thousands gathered** at the Lincoln Memorial for a decades-long D.C. Easter tradition. B1

The city of Takoma Park will pay \$1 million to a former police dispatcher to settle her sexual harassment and retaliation claims. B1
A bee farmer in Virginia says sabotage in the form of poisoning resulted in the deaths of about half a million insects at his farm. B1

STYLE **U.S. DOGE Service** staffers met with National Gallery of Art leaders last week, signaling that cuts or other changes may be on the way. C1
The latest novel in the Hunger Games series shows that fans are still craving more from author Suzanne Collins. C1

BUSINESS NEWS.....A11
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A12
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A6

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54193

